

Organizational Analysis Assignment

The purpose of this assignment is to use the models and theories of structure and power from the course to describe an organization you are familiar with. This could be the organization you currently work in, one you worked in the past, or one you can get good information about from others.

To qualify, the organization must have more than 50 employees and more than one level of hierarchy. If you work in a very large organization, you can focus on one coherent unit, such as a manufacturing plant or a geographical division. One functional unit, such as the IT department, may be large but lack sufficient structural differentiation to be useful for this assignment. If in doubt, check with Gervase.

To do a good job at this assignment, you may have to get information from other people in the organization to fill in what you know.

This assignment has three parts. I recommend you use these as subheadings.

Part 1 – Structure

In this section, use the course material to describe how work is divided and coordinated. It may be that the structure's logic differs across different parts of the organization. Note how the structure fits or doesn't fit the environment(s) it operates in.

Part 2 – Power

In this section, use the course materials to describe how power is designed and how it is actually used. Who gets influence and how? How are decisions made? It may be that power operates differently in different parts of the organization.

Part 3 – Effectiveness

In this section, offer your opinion about the effectiveness of how power and structure are designed in the organization. Does the structure and power fit together well? Do either or both fit or not fit the mission and environment in which the organization operates? What are its strengths and weaknesses? In this section, you must provide evidence to support your assertions about effectiveness. For example, the organization's ability to accomplish goals, beat its competitors, utilize human and other resources well, attract and retain talent, execute on strategy, or any other relevant objective measure of success/failure.

Grading

The paper has a maximum of 3,500 words, excluding any diagrams or tables. Only use diagrams and tables to help the reader understand your text. Never expect them to be self-explanatory.

I can't imagine how you might use AI to write this paper, but don't, other than Grammarly. Do not provide references to or applications of models or theories that are not part of the course materials. Doing so will raise suspicion.

Maximum points	
20	Readability. How easy is it to follow your train of thought? Is your coverage of Parts 1 and 2 focused yet thorough? Do you fill up too much space with redundant or tangential material?
40	Application of Course Materials. Do you demonstrate a solid understanding of what structure and power are? Do you apply models and theories accurately? Do you apply the right course materials to what you are describing?
40	Analysis of Effectiveness. How much depth of understanding do you demonstrate in Part 3? How well can you see the good, the bad, the opportunities, and the challenges? How good a job do you do of providing evidence to support your assertions?
100	Total

Please email me if you have any questions about the assignment.